

MB 409: Sales and Distribution Management

Course Code	MB 409
Course Name	Sales and Distribution Management
L-T-P-C	3-0-0-3
Prerequisites	Introduction to Marketing (MB 308)
Intended for	Integrated MBA
Mutual Exclusion	NA
Approval	64th BoA (May 2026), in the I-MBA curriculum; 65th BoA (Aug 2026)

Preamble

Sales and Distribution Management is a core marketing function that enables organizations to create customer value and achieve sustainable competitive advantage through effective sales strategies and channel management. With the growing importance of digital technologies, analytics, AI, and omnichannel business models, sales management has evolved into a strategic capability that integrates customer acquisition, relationship management, and distribution excellence. This course provides students with a comprehensive understanding of sales force management, distribution channel design, retail and key account management, and technology-enabled selling in both B2B and B2C contexts. The course equips students with the knowledge to design sales organizations, manage channel partners, formulate go-to-market strategies, leverage CRM and sales analytics, and address contemporary challenges in sales and distribution management.

Course Modules

- **Foundations of Sales Management and Personal Selling:** Strategic role of sales in organizations; Evolution of sales management; Sales and marketing interface; Consumer and organizational buying behaviour; B2B versus B2C selling; Sales process and sales cycle; Prospecting and lead generation; Consultative and solution selling; Handling objections and closing sales; Relationship selling and customer retention; Sales funnel and pipeline management; Fundamentals of sales forecasting. (8 hours)
- **Sales Force Organization and Performance Management:** Sales organization structures; Territory design and workload analysis; Sales potential estimation; Quota setting methods; Recruitment and selection of sales personnel; Sales training and development; Motivation theories in sales management; Compensation and incentive systems; Performance appraisal and sales metrics. (12 hours)
- **Distribution and Channel Management:** Functions and importance of marketing channels; Channel design decisions; Direct versus indirect distribution; Channel intensity strategies; Distributor and dealer management; Wholesalers, retailers, agents, and franchisees; Channel partner selection and evaluation; Channel power and dependence; Channel conflict and conflict resolution; Trade promotions and channel incentives; Rural distribution systems; Distribution challenges in emerging markets. (10 hours)
- **Retailing, Omnichannel Distribution and Key Account Management:** Retail formats and retail strategy; E-commerce and digital marketplaces; Direct-to-consumer (D2C) models; Quick commerce and last-mile delivery; Omnichannel retailing; Customer experience across channels; Key account planning and relationship management. (6 hours)
- **Sales Technology, Analytics and Emerging Trends:** Customer Relationship Management (CRM); Sales automation systems; Sales dashboards and KPIs; Sales forecasting analytics; AI applications in sales management; Ethics and governance in digital selling; Sustainability in sales and distribution. (6 hours)

Laboratory Modules

None

Text Books

1. Still, R. R., Cundiff, E. W., Govoni, N. A. P., & Puri, S. *Sales and Distribution Management: Decisions, Strategies and Cases*. (7e). Pearson Education.
2. Jobber, D., Lancaster, G., & Le Meunier-FitzHugh, K. (2024). *Selling and sales management* (12th ed.). Pearson.

References

1. González, J. (2025). *Route to Market: Design and Management of Distribution Channels*. IESE Publishing.
2. Toman, N., Adamson, B., & Gomez, C. (2017). *The New Sales Imperative*. Harvard Business Review, 95(2), 118–125.
3. Shapiro, B. P., & Posner, R. S. (2006). *Making the Major Sale* (HBR Classic). Harvard Business Review, 84(7–8), 142–148.
4. Sinha, P., Shastri, A., & Lorimer, S. (2024). *A Better Way to Link Sales and Marketing*. Harvard Business Review, 102(6), 116–125.
5. Harvard Business Review. (2017). *How to Predict Turnover on Your Sales Team*. Harvard Business Review, July–August 2017.
6. Adamson, B. (2022). *Sensemaking for Sales*. Harvard Business Review, 100(1), 122–129.